

Contact

matthew@isbelluk.net

www.linkedin.com/in/matthewisbell
(LinkedIn)

degreed.com/mattisbell/index/1
(Portfolio)

www.nexor.com (Company)

www.digitalforensicsmagazine.com
(Company)

Top Skills

Artificial Intelligence (AI)

SIEM

Identity and Access Management
(IAM)

Languages

English (Native or Bilingual)

French (Elementary)

Certifications

Career Essentials in Generative AI
by Microsoft and LinkedIn

Microsoft Certified Trainer
2022-2023

Mentor Gold

Social Responsibility Champ Gold
Mentor Silver

Honors-Awards

Microsoft Gold Club Choice Award

Freedom of the City of London

Publications

Covert Channels in Network
Protocols

Matthew Isbell

Cybersecurity Evangelist | Making security human, strategic and AI-ready | Speaker | TTRPG Nerd on the side

Bracebridge Heath, England, United Kingdom

Summary

I focus on threat detection and response, mainly XDR, SIEM, and how AI is reshaping the SOC. I'm particularly interested in how AI and security complement each other, but also where AI introduces new risks and attack vectors we're only starting to understand.

I like exploring ways to make security less reactive and more deliberate, especially in environments where alert fatigue and complexity are constant challenges.

Right now, I work with Independent Software Vendors (ISVs) across EMEA, helping them improve their security posture using the Microsoft security stack.

Outside of work, I run tabletop RPGs and talk a lot about storytelling, game design, and why good design choices matter everywhere, including security.

Always happy to talk about SOC modernisation, AI risks, or just how to make security work better without becoming another business blocker.

Experience

Microsoft

8 years 5 months

Senior Cyber Security Solutions Engineer - SDP EMEA ISV
April 2025 - Present (1 year 2 months)

Helping Independent Software Vendors across EMEA improve their security posture using the Microsoft Security stack.

My focus areas include:

- Designing and supporting threat detection and response architectures using Microsoft Sentinel and XDR technologies
- Embedding Zero Trust principles into ISV platforms and development lifecycles
- Enabling secure-by-design practices, with a focus on identity and access, least privilege, and assume breach modelling
- Exploring the intersection of AI and cybersecurity, both as a security accelerator and an emerging threat surface
- Acting as a technical advisor, trusted partner, and occasional reality check for security strategy and roadmap decisions

Dads@Microsoft UK LT - Families@Microsoft UK

July 2021 - Present (4 years 11 months)

United Kingdom

Community lead for Dads @ Microsoft UK, part of the wider Families Employee Resource Group.

- Supported working parents by creating safe spaces, resources, and honest discussions about modern fatherhood in corporate environments
- Acted as a voice to senior leadership, driving inclusion initiatives for fathers and caregivers
- Organised talks, workshops, and support networks on family life balance, career progression, and well-being

Senior Security Technical Specialist - UK

September 2022 - April 2025 (2 years 8 months)

Worked with Public Sector and Enterprise customers to design and adopt Microsoft security solutions, including:

- Microsoft Defender, Sentinel, and Defender for Cloud
- Practical application of Zero Trust models in complex organisations
- Supporting SOC modernisation efforts and reducing alert fatigue with integrated XDR workflows
- Advocating for identity-first security and automation-driven response

Apprentice Lead - Security - UK

November 2023 - March 2025 (1 year 5 months)

Lead for the security apprentice programme within Microsoft UK, helping develop the next generation of cybersecurity talent.

- Provided mentorship, technical coaching, and career guidance to apprentice cohorts

- Focused on building real-world security skills around threat detection, XDR, SIEM, and Zero Trust principles
- Advocated for clearer career pathways into cybersecurity, especially for non-traditional entrants

Security Technical Specialist - UK

January 2018 - September 2022 (4 years 9 months)

Reading, United Kingdom

Working with the newly formed Security Team within the Specialist Teams Unit at Microsoft UK. Responsible for being the technical point of contact to Public Sector customers during the Pre Sales process, driving adoption of M365 E5 Security Technologies, as well as Azure Sentinel and Azure Defender.

Worshipful Company of Information Technologists

8 years 7 months

Liveryman

October 2023 - Present (2 years 8 months)

City of London, England, United Kingdom

Freeman

November 2020 - October 2023 (3 years)

City of London, England, United Kingdom

Journeyman

November 2017 - November 2020 (3 years 1 month)

London, United Kingdom

Malt and Magic

Partner & Game Master

July 2020 - Present (5 years 11 months)

Directing partner and lead Game Master for Malt and Magic, a live-streamed TTRPG channel focused on immersive storytelling and community-building.

- Design and run narrative arcs across D&D and other systems
- Lead on lore development, player experience, and long-form story planning
- Balance creative leadership with digital production and community engagement
- Bonus: occasionally apply the same narrative logic to incident response plans

Digital Forensics Magazine

News Editor

October 2009 - Present (16 years 8 months)

Responsible for writing and management of news articles for both the website and magazine. Also responsible for designing and commissioning monthly newsletters and mailshots. Provide Graphic Design services to advertisers and the Magazine itself.

BluCreative Design Ltd

Director

May 2016 - February 2022 (5 years 10 months)

Lincoln, United Kingdom

Professional, affordable website and graphic design. My first solo venture. Currently taking commissions for my portfolio.

Projects:

www.fleetlinedespatch.co.uk

www.maltandmagic.co.uk

www.digitalforensicsmagazine.com

www.trmedia.co.uk

Nexor

Pre Sales Engineer / Solutions Engineer

June 2016 - December 2017 (1 year 7 months)

Nottingham, United Kingdom

Providing Technical Pre Sales support and technical expertise throughout the sales process. Responsible for collaborating with sales, services, development and technical support to ensure bids/tenders include technical solutions that accurately address the customer requirements and are adequately supported by key customer decision makers.

Deep Secure

Technical Consultant

May 2013 - June 2016 (3 years 2 months)

United Kingdom

I joined Deep Secure in May 2013 as the newest member of the Professional Services team, initially learning about the products, how to install them and how to troubleshoot. As a member of the PSO team, I provide 1st line support to Deep Secures customer base. As well as providing support PSO are a core team within the company, responsible for visiting customer sites to deliver new products, upgrades, patches or to provide on-site support.

As a result of my work at DeepSecure, my skill set and knowledge have increased dramatically to include knowledge of Solaris based systems, Trusted Solaris, further UNIX tools and techniques, Windows server environments, XMPP protocol and environments, as well as customer service skills and improvements to my presentation/demonstration skills.

Magnet Insurance Services Ltd

Developer

March 2013 - May 2013 (3 months)

Newark

Responsible for management of all IT systems and software. Performed some software development using Visual Basic, C# and ASP.NET.

Intelligent Cyber Strategies Ltd

Pre Sales/Technician

August 2012 - May 2013 (10 months)

Responsible for Website Design and Maintenance. Also a member of the Pre Sales Team helping to push our brand forward and get interest in the CHIMP platform

IAS Ltd

Head of Technical Services

September 2011 - February 2013 (1 year 6 months)

The Engine Shed

Event Operator

October 2008 - May 2010 (1 year 8 months)

Bar and Event Staff, served drinks and food, worked in the box office.

Education

De Montfort University

MSc, Forensic Computing · (2010 - 2011)

Lincoln College, UK

Higher National Certificate, Electrical and Electronics Engineering · (2012 - 2014)

University of Lincoln

BSc, Forensic Science · (2007 - 2010)

Ratcliffe College

High School, A Level & GCSE · (2002 - 2007)